

It was not as easy to speak to Mr. Kaufman as it was to speak to Mr. Crawford. Mr. Kaufman probably lived in Manhattan, but I couldn't swear to it. His home phone number wasn't listed, and Mr. Crawford said he'd never seen Henry at Sacco's coffee shop.

I called Mr. Kaufman at Salomon Brothers and was connected to a public relations officer. I was fortunate just to get to talk to this Mr. Brophy. After I explained I'd heard some great things about Mr. Kaufman's predictions, Mr. Brophy said that I might get an interview, but before I made a formal request it would be a good idea for me to read Mr. Kaufman's speeches. He made up a packet of several of them, dating back to 1981.

The packet was left for me at Adams and Rinehart, a public relations firm that represents Mr. Brophy, who in turn represents Mr. Kaufman. While riffling through this material, I wondered what Mr. Kaufman was saying on August 30, 1986, the day that Mr. Crawford issued his planetary sell. The closest thing I found was the speech Mr. Kaufman gave two days earlier at a Federal Reserve meeting in Jackson, Wyoming. In that speech, Mr. Kaufman made a few cautionary observations—such as, the U.S. deficit wasn't going away, our leaders were in a quandary, the financial system needed to be redefined, and so forth—but this was far from seeing the immediate danger in the Sun conjuncting with Mercury and Jupiter squaring Uranus, which had led Mr. Crawford to advise the selling of all stocks.

Not that Mr. Kaufman would have mentioned stocks in particular. Mr. Kaufman was not paid to be a stock-market timer. What he did, instead, was to lay out an overall course for the economy, which had a direct effect on stocks and bonds.

Having found no evidence of prescience in the Jackson speech, I went back to the earliest speech in the packet, April 22, 1981. Among many general statements about "cyclical patterns" and that sort of thing was a single clear-cut prediction. Mr. Kaufman was convinced that interest rates were going higher. "It is safe to say they will go very much higher than levels prevailing currently in all maturity sectors," was what he actually said.

Checking this against the results, I found that at the time Mr. Kaufman gave this speech the prevailing rate for long-term bonds